

APEX INSURANCE - COMPREHENSIVE CLAIM SETTLEMENT GUIDELINES

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1. Purpose and Claim Philosophy

Apex General & Life Insurance Corporation commits to equitable, transparent, and prompt settlement of all legitimate insurance claims. This manual articulates precise turnaround times (TAT), documentation prerequisites, and dispute handling protocols.

2. Turnaround Times (TAT) for Claim Settlement

The insurance company enforces stringent operational timelines governed by IRDAI (Protection of Policyholders' Interests) Regulations:

- **Health Cashless Hospitalization Claims:**

Initial cashless authorization approval or denial must be communicated within **1 hour (60 minutes)** of receipt of the pre-authorization request from network hospital. Final cashless discharge authorization must be finalized within **2 hours** of receiving complete final billing and discharge summary.

- **Health Reimbursement Claims:**

Admissible health reimbursement claims must be settled or rejected within **15 calendar days** from the date of receipt of the last necessary document from the claimant.

- **Life Insurance Non-Early Death Claims:**

For death claims arising on policies active for greater than 3 continuous years (where Section 45 applies), the entire claim settlement must be executed within **15 days** from the date of submission of all required claim papers.

- **Life Insurance Early Death Claims (Requiring Investigation):**

Where death occurs within 3 years of policy inception and investigation is necessitated to rule out non-disclosure or fraud: The investigation must be completed within **90 days** of claim intimation. The final claim settlement or repudiation must be concluded within **30 days** of investigation completion (maximum total TAT not exceeding 120 days).

- **Delayed Settlement Penal Interest:**

In case of any unexcused delay beyond the prescribed 15/30 day window, the insurer is legally liable to pay penal interest to the beneficiary at a rate of **2% above the prevailing bank rate** calculated from the date of receipt of the last document until actual disbursement.

3. Mandatory Claim Documentation Checklist

Claimants must furnish authentic documentation according to the claim category:

- **Health Claims:** Original detailed hospital discharge card, itemized final bill with payment receipts, diagnostic and lab test reports with prescriptions, doctor consultation notes, pharmacy purchase invoices, and indoor case papers (for surgical admissions).
- **Life Death Claims:** Duly executed death claim form, original death certificate issued by Municipal Corporation / Gram Panchayat, original policy document, claimant KYC (PAN and Aadhaar), cancelled cheque for NEFT credit, and Attending Physician's Medical Statement.
- **Accidental Death Claims:** In addition to standard death documents, submit certified copies of First Information Report (FIR), Police Inquest Panchnama, Post-Mortem Examination Report, and Medico-Legal Certificate (MLC).

4. Grievance Escalation & Insurance Ombudsman

If a claim is rejected or unresolved by the insurer's Grievance Redressal Officer within 15 days, the policyholder can register a grievance on the IRDAI Bima Bharosa portal or escalate the matter to the territorial Insurance Ombudsman within 1 year.